

Doc Id: MD-IT-001

Title: VPN Access Policy

Version: "1.0"

Effective Date: 2026-07-01

Owner Team: IT Infrastructure

Applies To: Meridian Dynamics employees and contractors using remote network access

Review Cadence: Annual

MD-IT-001 - VPN Access Policy

1. Purpose

This policy governs remote access to Meridian Dynamics internal services through the MeridianConnect VPN. It explains who may connect, which devices and authentication methods are allowed, how to diagnose common reports such as VPN keeps disconnecting, VPN times out from home, and connected but cannot reach the ERP, and when to escalate. MeridianConnect protects company traffic over an untrusted network; it does not repair an employee's home internet service. The intended result is reliable, auditable remote access without bypassing device, identity, or network security controls.

2. Scope

The policy applies to active employees and approved contractors who use a managed Meridian device outside a company office. Access is limited to services authorized for the user's role. Personal computers, rooted or jailbroken devices, shared household devices, and unmanaged virtual machines may not connect. A basic password or account lockout follows MD-IT-003, and a lost MFA device follows MD-IT-004. A home internet outage or weak home Wi-Fi is outside Meridian infrastructure ownership, although Service Desk may help identify that boundary under MD-IT-010. Suspicious certificate warnings, unexpected approval prompts, or evidence of credential theft are security incidents under MD-IT-008.

3. Definitions

MeridianConnect is the approved company VPN client and gateway. A managed device is company-enrolled, encrypted, patched, and reporting healthy security status. A tunnel is the protected network session created after sign-in and MFA. Employees may describe tunnel trouble as VPN drops, keeps disconnecting, times out, stuck connecting, or connected but no access. A local network problem exists when ordinary internet sites are also slow or unreachable before MeridianConnect starts. A service outage affects multiple users or locations. A certificate warning says the remote identity cannot be verified; users must not bypass it. Split access means public internet traffic and approved company traffic follow their configured routes.

4. Policy / Procedure

1. Connect from a managed device with current updates, disk encryption, and an enrolled MFA method. Use only the installed MeridianConnect client and the published gateway; browser extensions and third-party VPN clients are not approved.

2. Before troubleshooting, confirm ordinary internet access without opening confidential services. On hotel or guest Wi-Fi, complete the legitimate captive portal before starting MeridianConnect. Never accept a certificate warning or disable endpoint protection.
3. If MeridianConnect times out or keeps disconnecting, record the timestamp, network type, client error, whether ordinary internet remained available, and whether another approved network works. Restart the client once. Do not repeatedly approve MFA prompts.
4. If the tunnel connects but one application is unavailable, record the application and error. IT Infrastructure checks routes and DNS; Business Applications handles an application outage or missing license.
5. Service Desk may collect approved client diagnostics. IT Infrastructure may reset a stale VPN session after verifying identity. Employees must not post logs containing addresses or identifiers in public channels.

5. Priority & escalation

IT Infrastructure owns network_access and MeridianConnect incidents. One employee with intermittent VPN and a usable alternate network is medium urgency, P3, with a four-business-hour initial response. One employee fully blocked before a confirmed customer or operational deadline is high urgency, P2, with a thirty-minute initial response. A MeridianConnect outage affecting 10 or more users, two office locations, or a critical remote operation is critical urgency, P1, with immediate response under MD-IT-002. A certificate warning, repeated unexpected MFA prompts, or suspected credential disclosure changes the category to security_incident and transfers ownership to IT Security immediately. A personal internet-provider outage is routed to Service Desk for general guidance and is not represented as a Meridian service failure.

6. Related documents

MD-IT-002 defines the impact and urgency matrix for P1 P4 assignment. MD-IT-003 governs password reset and lockout when the VPN credential is rejected. MD-IT-004 governs MFA enrollment and lost-authenticator recovery. MD-IT-008 governs suspicious prompts, certificate warnings, and credential disclosure. MD-IT-010 defines supported remote networks, managed-device standards, and the boundary around personal internet service.

7. Revision history

Version 1.0 became effective on 2026-07-01. It establishes managed-device-only access, approved diagnostics, the 10-user P1 threshold, clear ownership between IT Infrastructure and Business Applications, and mandatory security escalation for certificate or credential concerns.